Version 1.0.0

FlorindoLAB

File Renamer · User guide

1. Overview

File Renamer renames files and folders in bulk. It is **free**, works **offline**, needs no account and no installation: it is a single file that you run. Nothing is sent over the Internet.

- **Stackable rules**: you pile up operations (replace, remove, number, date…) and each one works on the result of the previous one.
- **A live preview**: the new name of every file is shown before anything changes, and nothing is touched until you confirm.
- **Safeguards**: conflicts are detected in advance, no file is ever overwritten, and undo is reliable, even after closing the program.
- **Presets**: you save your chain of rules to reuse it or share it.

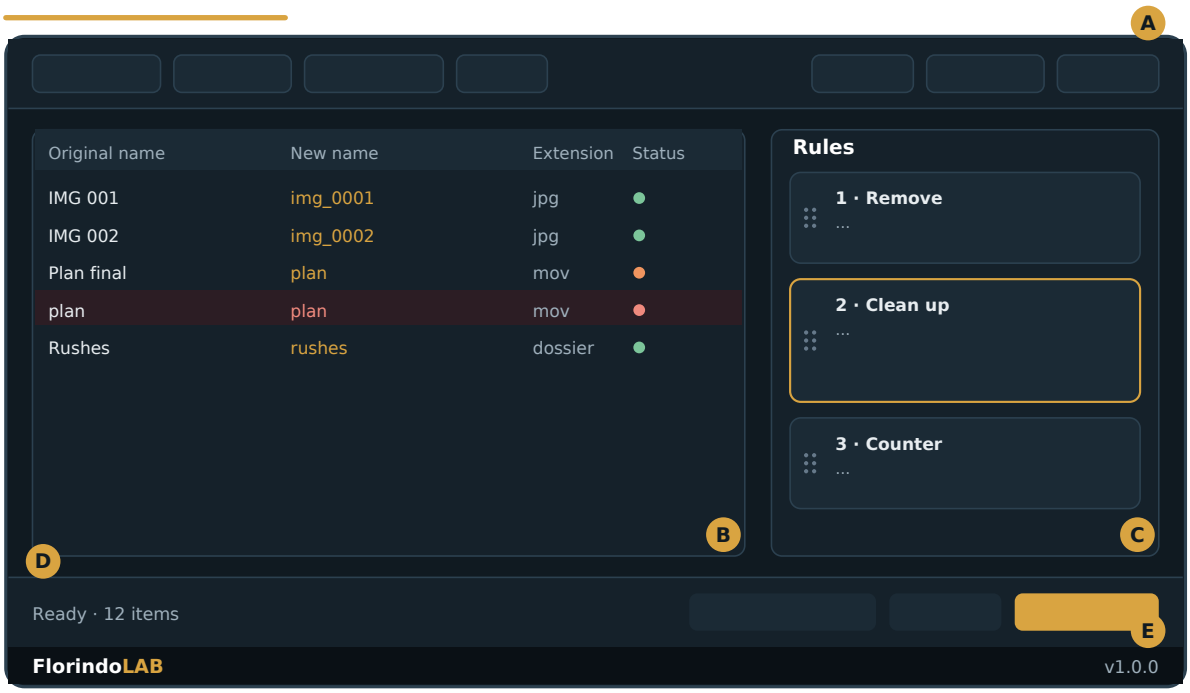
Runs on Windows 10 and Windows 11 (64-bit).

2. Quick start

1. **Run** `FileRenamer.exe` from a folder of your choice. At the first launch (which may take a few seconds), it creates a “data” folder next to itself to keep your settings and history.
2. **Add files**: drag them into the window, or use “Add files” / “Add a folder”.
3. **Add rules**: “Add a rule”, pick one from the list, set it up. The “New name” column updates as you type.
4. **Check** the “Status” column: everything should be “Ready”. A red row means a problem (hover over the row to read the explanation). “Simulate” gives a full report without changing anything.
5. **Rename**: use the button at the bottom, then confirm. If you slip, use “Undo last rename”.

> **Tip.** Try it on copies of a few files first. The preview and undo keep the risk low, but it is the best way to get familiar with it.

3. Tour of the interface



A **Toolbar**

Add files, Add a folder, Load a preset, Save; the “Show extensions” checkbox; the Simple / Advanced mode switch; the language button (Français / English); History.

B **File list**

Columns “Original name”, “New name”, “Extension” and “Status”. A small yellow folder icon marks folders. “Remove” (or the Delete key) takes items off the list without touching the files; “Clear list” empties everything; “Sort by” changes the order (which also sets the order of counters). “Include subfolders” and “Also add folders” control what an added folder brings in. Above the table, the Include / Exclude filter.

C **Rules panel**

One card per rule, from top to bottom in execution order. On each card: the six-dot handle to drag and drop the rule, the checkbox to turn it on or off, the up and down arrows, the gear (show or hide the settings) and the trash can.

D **Bottom bar**

A status message and counters (number of items, to rename, excluded…), then “Undo last rename”, “Simulate” and “Rename”.

E **FlorindoLAB strip**

The brand and the version number, handy when reporting a problem.

4. The rules

Rules apply **from top to bottom**: each one receives the name produced by the previous one. You can reorder them (handle or arrows), turn them off without deleting them, and see their settings by clicking the gear.

Rule	What it does	Example
Search / replace	Replaces text; match case or not; all occurrences or only the first.	“Mon Plan” → “Mon_Plan” (space → _)

Rule	What it does	Example
Remove	Removes a prefix, a suffix, some text, a range of characters, or the first / last characters.	EXPORT_Plan → Plan
Add text	Adds text at the start or the end of the name (before the extension).	Plan → project_Plan
Insert text	Inserts text at a position, counted from the start or from the end.	ABCDEF + “-” at 3 → ABC-DEF
Change case	lowercase, UPPERCASE, Title Case, or first letter only.	my plan → My Plan
Clean up	Removes extra spaces, replaces spaces with _, - or ., removes characters Windows does not allow, normalizes accents.	Été à la mer → Ete_a_la_mer
Counter	Numbers items: start, step, number of digits, position, separator. Can restart in each folder.	img → img_0001, img_0002…
Add a date	Inserts the file's modified or created date, in the format you want, with an optional offset.	plan → 2026-10-11_plan
Extension	Lowercases or uppercases the extension, replaces it or removes it. Never converts the file.	photo.JPG → photo.jpg
Limit length	Keeps the first or last N characters of the name.	A very long name… → A very
Reorder the name (Advanced)	Splits the name at a separator and puts the parts back in another order.	SHOT_010_v03, order 3,2,1 → v03_010_SHOT
Regular expression (Advanced)	Pattern search using .NET syntax, with groups ($1, $2…) to rearrange.	(\d+)_(\w+) → $2_$1

> **Extension protected.** On the search and remove cards, the “Leave the extension alone” checkbox is checked by default: only the name is processed. Unchecking it makes the extension part of the text (for example to replace “.jpeg” with “.jpg”).

5. Simple mode, Advanced mode, conditions and filter

Simple mode offers the everyday rules. **Advanced** mode adds “Reorder the name”, “Regular expression”, the precise choice of what a rule processes (the name, the extension, the full name) and conditions. Switching modes never changes the rules you already created.

Conditions: “Apply this rule only if…”

Each rule can act on some items only. The others pass this rule unchanged. The criterion can be the name, the extension, the full name, the type (file or folder), the size or a date. It is evaluated on the value the rule receives at that step, so after the previous rules.

- The extension **is equal to** mov: the rule only touches .mov videos.
- The size **is larger than** 10 MB (units: KB, MB, GB).
- The modified date **is after** 2026-10-01 (format yyyy-mm-dd, optionally with the time).
- The name **matches the regular expression** … for finer cases.

List filter: Include and Exclude

The filter decides which items are part of the batch. Items left out stay in the list, **greyed out** with the status “Excluded”: they are neither renamed nor counted by counters. “Exclude” always wins over “Include”. You can separate several patterns with “;”.

Pattern typed	Meaning
*.mov	every name ending in .mov (the * wildcard stands for anything)
IMG_*	every name starting with IMG_
plan??.png	the ? wildcard stands for exactly one character
.jpg	the exact extension .jpg
final	every name containing “final”

The type menu can also keep only files, or only folders.

6. Preview, statuses and conflicts

The preview updates live and never modifies the disk. The “Rename” button stays locked as long as a conflict or an error remains.

Status	Meaning
Ready	Renaming is possible.
Unchanged	The rules do not change this name.
Conflict	Two items in the same folder would get the same name, or this name is already taken by another file.
Invalid	The name is impossible on Windows: forbidden character, reserved name (CON, NUL, COM1…), empty name, trailing dot or space, name or path too long.
Error	A rule could not be applied to this item (invalid pattern, date unavailable, unreadable condition…).
Locked	The file seems to be in use by another program, or is read-only. Renaming is still possible but may fail.
Excluded	Left out by the list filter.

An **extension change** or the **removal of an extension** is not blocking, but it is flagged on hover and recalled in the confirmation window.

7. Rename, undo, history

- **No file is ever overwritten.** A name already taken by a file outside the batch is a conflict; the situation is checked again at the last moment.
- **Swaps and chains**: two files swapping their names (A ↔ B) are handled with temporary names. If a step fails, the whole group is put back in its original state.
- **A file that fails** (locked, permissions) does not stop the others: a report says what could not be done.

- **Simulate** shows the full plan (renames, conflicts, swaps) without changing anything.
- **Undo last rename** restores the original names. Items that changed since (moved, or whose old name was taken by another file) are left untouched and reported: undo never overwrites anything.
- **History**: every session is kept, even after the program is closed. You can look at the details of a session and undo it.

8. Presets and templates

A **preset** is a chain of rules saved in a `.frpreset` file: “Save” creates the file, “Load a preset” opens it again. It is also the way to share a setup. The program automatically remembers the last list of rules you used and brings it back at the next launch. Old `.frscn` files can still be read.

The “Load a preset” menu also offers ready-made **templates**, which you can edit and save under another name:

- Clean up names
- Number files (Image_0001)
- Lowercase with underscores
- Remove a version suffix (_FINAL, _v2)
- Modified date as a prefix (2026-10-11_name)
- Lowercase extensions
- Normalize accents and special characters

9. Language, data and portability

The language button in the toolbar switches between **Français** and **English** instantly; your choice is remembered. At the very first launch, the Windows language is used.

File Renamer is **portable**: it keeps its data in the `data` folder, next to `FileRenamer.exe`.

Item	Purpose
data\journal	History of renames (one file per session), used for undo.
data\presets	Default folder for your presets.
data\state.json	Last list of rules, mode and options.
data\language.txt	The language you chose.
data\error.log	Error log, to attach to a problem report.

If the program's folder is not writable (for example in “Program Files”), data is stored in `%APPDATA%\FlorindoLAB\FileRenamer`. To move the program, copy `FileRenamer.exe` together with its `data` folder (to keep settings and history); to remove it, delete both: nothing else is installed on the computer.

10. Frequently asked questions

Windows shows “Windows protected your PC”

This is the Windows SmartScreen screen, shown for little-known or digitally unsigned programs. To check that the downloaded file is intact, compare its SHA-256 fingerprint with the one shown on the download page:

```
Get-FileHash .\FileRenamer.exe -Algorithm SHA256
```

If both fingerprints are identical, click “More info”, then “Run anyway”. An antivirus may also react to a recent program: the file can be submitted to it for analysis.

Does changing the extension convert my file?

No. Renaming a “.mov” file to “.mp4” only changes its name: the content is still that of a .mov file.

Why is a file “Locked”?

Another program is using it (video player, editor, folder sync…) or it is read-only. Close the program concerned, then refresh the preview by changing a rule.

Can I undo after closing the program?

Yes, as long as the files have not been moved or renamed again in the meantime: the history is kept on disk.

11. Known limitations of version 1.0.0

- Windows only (10 and 11, 64-bit).
- One condition per rule (no “and / or” combinations).
- The dates used are file system dates; reading metadata (photo EXIF, audio tags) and importing a list of names are not available yet.
- A folder together with its own contents in a name swap is not supported.
- Names or paths that would exceed Windows limits (255 characters for a name, 260 for a path) are refused.

12. Reporting a problem

To make a report useful, please give: the **version number** (in the FlorindoLAB strip at the bottom of the window, and in the title bar), the **steps** to reproduce the problem, and attach the `data\error.log` file if it exists. You can reach me through the software's page on florindolab.com.